Partners of the Americas' A Ganar Youth Safeguarding and Protection Policy

The *A Ganar Youth Safeguarding and Protection Policy*, which has been adapted from Partners' *United States Youth Safeguarding and Protection Policy* is intended to provide a safe and healthy environment for all youth participating in the A Ganar program; to provide clarity on the roles and expectations for youth, staff, and volunteers; to provide a mechanism for vetting all potential A Ganar staff and volunteers; and to provide a way for those in any way involved with the program to air any causes for concern.

The following policy is in place and all of the necessary documents for vetting staff and volunteers, for training staff in youth protection, and for airing concerns are available for all of our Country Coordinating Organizations and Implementing Organizations to use. These documents include:

- **Incident Report Form:** A document where any incident should be recorded and submitted to your Regional Coordinator.
- **A Ganar Code of Conduct:** A document outlining the expected behavior of all persons affiliated with the A Ganar program.
- **Volunteer Application:** A form to be filled out by all potential A Ganar volunteers.
- **Reference Check Form:** A form to be filled out by references of potential A Ganar staff or volunteers.
- **Notice for Concern:** A document to be filled out should any A Ganar staff or volunteers be demonstrating concerning behavior with/towards youth.
- **Background Check Release:** A form to be filled out by potential A Ganar staff or volunteers consenting to a background check.
- **Youth Safeguarding and Protection Policy Acknowledgement:** A form to be signed by A Ganar staff or volunteers acknowledging that they have read and will adhere to it.
- **Training Materials:** Youth protection training materials provided for reference at any time.

In addition, there is an A Ganar Pledge that all A Ganar staff/volunteers and program participants must adhere to.

Should your organization believe that parts of this mechanism are not ideal for your organization, it is necessary to discuss the alternate methods that you will use to vet/train staff and to allow for proper airing of youth safety concerns with Partners and to receive approval. Additionally, should your organization already have a Youth Protection Policy in place you may use it upon receiving approval from Partners.